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LEVEL 2 · LEARNER MANUAL

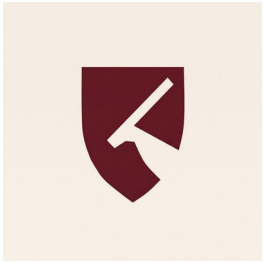
Safety Representative and Site Safety Officer

Safety. Preparedness. Competence.

Author: Tangi Iigonda

Oryx Institute · Oryx Safety Academy

Five days · Ten modules · Certificate of Completion



Safety Representative and Site Safety Officer — Learner Manual

Oryx Safety Academy · Oryx Institute

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Authored by Tangi Iigonda.

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Contact: info@oryxinstitute.org

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Welcome from the Principal

Welcome to Level 2. You are here because someone, an employer, a site manager, a crew, has decided you carry responsibility for other people's safety as well as your own. That trust is the real qualification this course works toward; the certificate is its receipt.

Five days from now you will have run a real risk assessment, investigated an incident on paper, written a permit, delivered a toolbox talk to a live room, and walked a site with an inspector's eyes. None of it is theory for its own sake. Oryx teaches the way Namibian sites actually work, with the law, the practical standards, and the honest labels on each.



Tangi Iigonda, Principal and Founder, Oryx Institute

About this course

Field	Detail
Duration	Five days (approximately 33 contact hours including practical walkthrough)
Audience	Designated workplace safety representatives, junior safety officers and site supervisors in construction, mining, logistics, manufacturing, agriculture, hospitality and office environments.
Entry requirement	Level 1 General Worker Safety Induction or equivalent workplace safety induction; literacy in English sufficient for report writing. Site experience is an advantage, not a requirement.
Assessment	Fifty-question written examination (80% pass), a practical risk-assessment exercise, a ten-minute assessed toolbox talk, and an observed site walkthrough. All rubrics are published to learners in advance.
Certificate	Certificate of Completion — Safety Officer Level 2 (internal credential; not an NQF qualification at launch)

Field	Detail
Materials	Printed learner manual and workbook, clipboard and pen on day one, and the Level 2 green hard hat, yours to keep.
Practical arrangements	The extinguisher practical is delivered by a qualified fire-training provider; the site walkthrough runs at a partner site under a signed arrangement. Both are scheduled during the course.

Certification status, stated plainly: the Oryx Safety Academy is not yet a registered vocational training provider with the Namibia Training Authority, and this certificate is not an NQF qualification. It is an internal record of completion of Oryx training. It does not by itself appoint you as a legally designated safety officer, and it does not replace First Aid Level 1 or fire certification, which are issued by registered partners. Formal vocational programmes commence only after NTA provider registration is granted; NQA accreditation is being pursued in parallel and will be announced on the public register.

The five days

Day	Focus
Day 1	The legal framework in depth; HIRA methodology and the group risk-assessment exercise
Day 2	Incident investigation; PPE management and registers
Day 3	Emergency planning and fire, including the provider-led extinguisher practical; first aid awareness
Day 4	Construction safety; toolbox talks; safety files; walkthrough briefing
Day 5	The assessed site walkthrough; final examination; assessed toolbox talks

How to use this manual: each module carries outcomes, terminology, teaching content, a worked example, an activity and a knowledge check. The knowledge checks are practice; the final examination is marked separately and draws evenly across the ten modules. Keep the manual after the course, it is designed as your first desk reference.

Module 1 The Namibian occupational safety framework in depth

Contact time: 3 hours · *Oryx Safety Academy*

1.1 What this module covers

Level 1 taught the duties. This module maps the whole framework a safety representative works inside: the Act, the regulations, the compensation system, the inspectorate, and the industry standards used as good practice even where they are not Namibian law. The goal is a working reference you can quote accurately in a meeting.

1.2 Learning outcomes

By the end of this module you should be able to:

- Summarise the structure of Namibian occupational safety law: the Labour Act, 2007, GN 156 of 1997, and the pending OSH Bill.
- Explain what a labour inspector may lawfully do on a site visit, and what records they may ask to see.
- Distinguish clearly between Namibian statute, international standards, and South African standards used as good practice.
- Describe the employees' compensation system and the reporting chain after a workplace injury.
- Locate the primary sources, so claims can be checked rather than remembered.

1.3 Key terminology

Term	Working definition
Statutory instrument	Law made under an Act, such as a regulation or government notice.
Good practice	A recognised standard or method that is not law, but which a court or inspector may treat as evidence of reasonable practice.
Improvement notice	An inspector's written instruction requiring a breach to be fixed within a stated time.
Prohibition notice	An inspector's instruction stopping an activity that involves risk of serious personal injury.

1.4 The Act and the regulations

The Labour Act, 2007 (Act No. 11 of 2007) is the statute. Its health, safety and welfare provisions create the employer's duty of care and the employee's reciprocal duties. The operative detail lives in Government Notice 156 of 1997, the regulations relating to the health and safety of employees at work, made under the 1992 Labour Act and carried forward. Between them they cover hazard identification and risk assessment, environmental conditions, machinery safety, PPE, first aid and emergency arrangements, and record-keeping.

A safety representative who has read the regulations once, with a pencil, is more useful on site than one who has read summaries ten times. Bring the gazetted text into the course; several exercises use it directly.

1.5 What is coming: the OSH Bill

The Occupational Safety and Health Bill drafted in 2024 is before Parliament at the time of writing. As drafted, it points toward a standalone OSH Act with, among other things, mandatory safety committees for larger employers, attention to psychosocial risks, and substantially higher penalties. It is not law yet. Nothing in this course assumes any provision of the Bill; when it is enacted, this course will be reviewed against it, and the public register will note the change. Present tense in a safety meeting should always describe current law.

1.6 The inspectorate and enforcement

Labour inspectors of the Ministry of Labour, Industrial Relations and Employment Creation may enter, inspect and examine workplaces at reasonable times; take photographs and samples; question persons; and require production of records. Where they find a breach they may issue instructions; serious risk can attract a stopping instruction. Inspectorate staffing is limited relative to the number of Namibian workplaces, which is precisely why employer-side structures, safety representatives, committees, and training carry most of the preventive load in practice.

Treat an inspection as a normal event with a prepared response: a person designated to accompany the inspector, records filed where they can be found, and a culture of fixing findings rather than hiding them.

1.7 Compensation and the SSC

Work injuries flow into the Employees' Compensation Ordinance of 1946 as amended, administered through the Employees' Compensation Fund of the Social Security Commission, established under the Social Security Act, 1994. The employer reports prescribed injuries on the Commission's forms within

prescribed timeframes; the employee supplies facts and keeps copies. The safety representative's role in the chain is factual: accurate incident records make or break claims, and delays cost workers money.

1.8 Statute, standard, and good practice

Three layers exist and must not be blurred. Namibian statute is binding. International standards such as ISO 45001:2018 and ILO instruments are voluntary benchmarks. South African instruments, SANS standards and the South African construction regulations, are frequently used on Namibian projects by clients and contractors, and there is nothing wrong with following them, provided nobody claims they are Namibian law. When you write “required” in a safety file, you should be able to name the requirement's source, and “good practice, SANS 10085” is an honest way to cite a voluntary standard.

1.7 Worked example

Worked example: A client's site audit scores a Windhoek contractor zero for “non-compliance with Construction Regulations 2014, reg 5”. The safety officer checks: those are South African regulations, promulgated under South Africa's OHS Act. They bind nobody in Namibia as law, though the client may write them into the contract as a standard, which is legitimate. The officer replies in writing: the contractor complies with the Labour Act and GN 156 as law, adopts the cited regulation as contractual good practice, and notes one genuine gap against it with a dated fix plan. The auditor accepts. Precision, not defensiveness, closed the finding.

1.8 Activity and knowledge check

LEARNER ACTIVITY

Source or opinion?

The facilitator reads ten safety statements aloud, for example “hard hats must be replaced every two years” or “work at height above two metres needs a permit”. For each, your table decides: Namibian statute, contractual requirement, international standard, or unverified industry opinion. For every item placed in the last category, write what you would check and where. Be ready to defend one answer to the room.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

The Namibian occupational safety framework in depth — check your

understanding

1. Name the statute and the regulation that together form the current core of Namibian employee health and safety law.

2. A labour inspector arrives at your site. List three things the inspector may lawfully do.

3. The OSH Bill 2024 is currently…

   A. Law

   B. Before Parliament, not yet law

   C. Repealed

4. Which fund compensates injured workers, and under which ordinance?

5. A client demands compliance with a South African SANS standard on a Namibian site. What is the correct professional response?

1.9 Module summary

- Labour Act, 2007 plus GN 156 of 1997 is the operative framework; the OSH Bill is pending.
- Inspectors enter, question, inspect records, and instruct.
- Compensation flows through the SSC's Employees' Compensation Fund.
- Never present a SANS or ISO document as Namibian law; cite it as good practice.

Module 2 Hazard identification and risk assessment (HIRA)

Contact time: 3.5 hours · *Oryx Safety Academy*

2.1 What this module covers

HIRA is the working heart of the safety officer's job. This module teaches the full cycle: identifying hazards systematically, scoring risk on a matrix, choosing controls in the correct order, documenting the assessment so others can use it, and reviewing it when things change. You will produce a real risk assessment during the course and be assessed on one.

2.2 Learning outcomes

By the end of this module you should be able to:

- Run a structured hazard identification across a work area, using task-based and area-based sweeps.
- Score risks on a five-by-five likelihood-severity matrix and explain the score to a supervisor.
- Select controls using the hierarchy of control, in writing, with reasons.
- Document a risk assessment that a third party can follow, and state the triggers that force its review.
- Present risk information to workers in a form they can act on.

2.3 Key terminology

Term	Working definition
HIRA	Hazard identification and risk assessment: the structured cycle of finding hazards and judging risk.
Residual risk	The risk that remains after controls are applied.
Risk matrix	A grid of likelihood against severity used to rank risks consistently.
Task-based sweep	Hazard identification that follows one job step by step.
Area-based sweep	Hazard identification that walks one physical area systematically.

2.4 Finding hazards like a professional

Amateurs look at a workplace; professionals divide it. Walk an area in a fixed pattern, looking high, low, behind, and at what moves. Then take the top five tasks in that area and break each into steps, asking at every step what can go wrong here, to whom, and how badly. Combine both sweeps with the three quiet sources people forget: past incident records, manufacturers' instructions, and the workers themselves, who know where the job actually hurts.

Write findings as hazard statements, not topics. “Fall from height” is a topic. “Worker on unguarded mezzanine edge while stacking pallets, fall of 2.8 m onto concrete” is a hazard statement you can score and control.

2.5 Scoring on the matrix

A five-by-five matrix keeps judgement consistent between assessors. Likelihood runs from rare (1) to almost certain (5); severity runs from negligible (1), no treatment needed, through serious injury (4) to fatality (5). The cell score is the product. Convention on this course: 1 to 4 accept with monitoring; 5 to 12

control within the planning cycle; 15 and above stop work until controlled. The numbers are a communication device, not a truth machine; two assessors who differ by a point should discuss the hazard, not average their arithmetic.

Score the worst credible outcome, not the worst imaginable one. “Scaffold collapse could kill someone” is imaginable; “installer slips from an unguarded platform, 2.8 m, fracture or worse” is credible and actionable.

Likelihood ↓ / Severity →	Negligible (1)	Minor (2)	Serious (3)	Major (4)	Fatality (5)
Rare (1)	1 · Monitor	2 · Monitor	3 · Monitor	4 · Monitor	5 · Control
Unlikely (2)	2 · Monitor	4 · Monitor	6 · Control	8 · Control	10 · Control
Possible (3)	3 · Monitor	6 · Control	9 · Control	12 · Control	15 · Stop
Likely (4)	4 · Monitor	8 · Control	12 · Control	16 · Stop	20 · Stop
Almost certain (5)	5 · Control	10 · Control	15 · Stop	20 · Stop	25 · Stop

Table 2.1: The course five-by-five risk matrix. Bands: 1–4 monitor; 5–12 control within the planning cycle; 15 and above stop work until controlled. Band labels are printed in the cells so the table remains readable in black-and-white printing and for colour-blind users.

2.6 Controls in the right order

For each hazard, work the hierarchy from the top and write down why the higher options fail before accepting a lower one. Eliminate: can the task be done from the ground instead of at height? Substitute: is there a less hazardous chemical? Engineering: guard, extract, barricade. Administrative: permits, procedures, training, rotation. Personal protective equipment last, because it protects one person, some of the time, if worn correctly. An assessment that jumps straight to gloves is an assessment half done, and inspectors and auditors alike recognise it on sight.

2.7 Documentation and review

A usable assessment records: the activity and location, the hazard statements, initial scores, chosen controls with reasons, residual scores, who assessed and when, and the review date. Reviews are forced by triggers: change of process, equipment, chemicals or people; an incident or worrying near miss; a fixed interval, commonly twelve months for stable operations. An assessment that predates the new machine beside the workbench is not an assessment of the workplace anyone currently works in.

2.7 Worked example

Worked example: A bottling plant in Otjiwarongo assesses its crate-washing bay. Task sweep of one cycle finds: steam scald at the wash tunnel mouth; slip on wet

floor between tunnel and stacker; crush between stacker and wall; chemical splash from caustic dosing. Initial scores: scald 3x4=12, slip 4x3=12, crush 2x5=10, splash 2x4=8. Controls, in hierarchy order: a fixed tunnel mouth screen (engineering) drops scald to 4; drainage grid plus boot rule and squeegee rota (engineering + administrative) drops slip to 8; mirror and marked walkway (engineering + administrative) drops crush to 4; splash is handled with a closed dosing system quote (engineering, pending) and, until fitted, face shield and apron at changeover (PPE, interim), holding splash at 8 with a dated engineering action. Note the honest interim line: PPE holding the gap until the higher control arrives, with a date, is good practice, not a failure.

2.8 Activity and knowledge check

LEARNER ACTIVITY

Assess the bay

In groups of three, use the crate-wash bay layout and photographs provided. Produce a one-page risk assessment: minimum six hazard statements, scored, with hierarchy-ordered controls and residual scores, assessor names and a review trigger. One group presents; the class audits it against the checklist: statements specific, scores defensible, hierarchy respected, review dated.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Hazard identification and risk assessment (HIRA) — check your understanding

1. Write a hazard statement, not a topic, for an unguarded mezzanine edge used for stacking.
2. On the course 5x5 matrix, a hazard scores 3x5=15. What does convention require?
   A. Accept with monitoring
   B. Control within the planning cycle
   C. Stop work until controlled
3. Why does the hierarchy demand engineering before PPE?
4. List four triggers that force a risk assessment review.
5. What is residual risk?

2.9 Module summary

- Divide the workplace by area and by task; use records, manuals and workers.
- Hazard statements are specific; scores use worst credible outcomes.
- Work the hierarchy in writing; PPE is interim or last.
- Documents carry names, dates and review triggers.

Module 3 Incident investigation and reporting

Contact time: 3 hours · *Oryx Safety Academy*

3.1 What this module covers

When something goes wrong, the safety officer becomes the company's memory. This module covers the first hour after an incident, evidence handling, a structured cause method that reaches system faults rather than blaming the nearest worker, and the written report. It also covers the near-miss programme that prevents the investigation ever being needed.

3.2 Learning outcomes

By the end of this module you should be able to:

- Manage the first response to an incident: treatment, scene control, notification.
- Preserve evidence, physical, documentary and human, to a defensible standard.
- Investigate causes with the five-whys method extended to system level.
- Write an incident report with findings, causes and corrective actions that closes the loop.
- Operate a near-miss reporting routine that workers actually use.

3.3 Key terminology

Term	Working definition
Immediate cause	The direct act or condition in the final seconds before the incident.
Underlying cause	The system fault that allowed the immediate cause to exist, such as a missing inspection or an unenforced rule.

Term	Working definition
Corrective action	A dated, owned change that removes a cause, not a restatement of the rule that failed.
Scene control	Physically holding the incident location unchanged until evidence is captured.

3.4 The first hour

Order of operations: treat and protect people first, including the rescue's own safety; then control the scene, barrier it, photograph it before anything moves, and note who was present; then notify, supervisor, management, and where prescribed, the authorities; then capture perishable evidence, memories fade overnight, spills dry, screens get logged over. Serious injuries and fatalities involve the police and the labour inspectorate; in those cases the scene is not yours alone, and nothing is moved until the authorities release it.

3.5 Asking why until it hurts the system

The five-whys technique asks why repeatedly until the chain reaches a management decision. “Worker's hand was cut on the guillotine”: why, guard was up but the sensor was bypassed; why, the sensor nuisance-tripped and production pushed to keep the line running; why, the sensor had been faulty for three weeks and there was no maintenance call-out; why, the defect list had no owner and no deadline; why, maintenance scheduling has no minimum response standard. The first why names a worker's hand; the last names a system. Correct the last, and the next worker's hand is safe for reasons that do not depend on memory.

Blame ends investigations early and guarantees repetition. Interviews ask for recollection in the person's own order, without leading questions, with notes read back and signed. Witness statements taken the same day outperform statements taken “tomorrow or later” by a wide margin.

3.6 The report and the loop

A defensible report states: the sequence of events with times; the immediate cause; the underlying causes; the corrective actions, each with an owner and a date; and the verification step, who confirms completion and how. Reports are written in plain language and circulated to the people who can act. An action list without owners and dates is a wish list.

Compensation documentation runs parallel: the employer's report to the Employees' Compensation Fund, with the incident record attached. Factual, dated, consistent; the fund's decision depends on it.

3.7 Near misses as the main product

A mature reporting culture produces dozens of near-miss reports for every injury. That ratio is not bureaucracy; it is discount-priced prevention. Make reporting easy, one page, no blame, with feedback published so reporters see outcomes. Safety representatives are the engine here: ask for reports at every meeting, thank the reporters by role, and publish what changed.

3.7 Worked example

Worked example: A forklift clips a rack leg at a Walvis Bay depot; no injury; upright bends. First hour: area barricaded, photos taken from four angles, driver's statement taken same day, defect item raised for the rack. Investigation: why did the truck clip the leg, aisle width reduced by a pallet overhang; why was the pallet there, an inbound delivery was staged in the aisle; why was it staged there, the staging bay was occupied by an unscheduled contractor's vehicle; why was the vehicle in the staging bay, the visitor gate process does not route drivers to parking. Corrective actions: rack upright inspected and replaced by name and date; staging rule re-issued with floor markings; visitor routing changed with the gate guard inducted. Verification: safety officer signs each closed item, and the next monthly inspection checks the aisle specifically.

3.8 Activity and knowledge check

LEARNER ACTIVITY

Investigate the spill

Groups receive a written scenario pack: an acid drum leak at a battery depot with two first-aid-level injuries and a supervisor who wants the mess cleaned before the client's visit. Produce: a first-hour action list, an evidence plan, a five-whys chain, and three corrective actions with owners and dates. The class plays the client's auditor and tries to find an unanswered question in each report.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Incident investigation and reporting — check your understanding

1. List the first-hour priorities in order.

2. In a serious-injury case, who controls the scene?
   A. The safety officer alone
   B. The police and labour inspectorate once involved; nothing moves until released
   C. The site manager's discretion
3. The five-whys method stops when…
   A. A worker admits error
   B. The chain reaches a management system fault
   C. Five questions have been asked regardless
4. What makes a corrective action real?
5. Why do near-miss programmes matter more than injury investigations?

3.9 Module summary

- People, scene, notification, perishable evidence, in that order.
- Investigate to system level; blame ends investigations early.
- Actions carry owners, dates and verification.
- Near misses are the cheapest lessons a site will ever get.

Module 4 PPE inspection and management

Contact time: 3 hours · *Oryx Safety Academy*

4.1 What this module covers

Level 1 covered wearing PPE. This module covers running a PPE programme: selecting correctly against a hazard, issuing with records, inspecting on a schedule, storing, replacing, and retiring. A managed programme is auditable; a box of gloves is not.

4.2 Learning outcomes

By the end of this module you should be able to:

- Build a PPE matrix linking each role's hazards to specified equipment, including standards markings.
- Set up issue and inspection records that survive an audit.
- Inspect and correctly retire common items, hard hats, harnesses, respirators, gloves, boots.
- Manage storage and hygiene for shared and personal equipment.

- Recognise the markings that indicate protection level, including EN and equivalent standards, and what they do not mean.

4.3 Key terminology

Term	Working definition
PPE matrix	A table linking roles, hazards, specified PPE, and standards or specifications.
Issue record	A signed record of what equipment was issued to whom, when, and in what condition.
Retirement	Removing an item from service permanently; distinct from cleaning or repair.
EN standard marking	The European norm markings, such as EN 397 on helmets, commonly cited on PPE sold in southern Africa; a specification reference, not a Namibian legal requirement.

4.4 The matrix

Start from the risk assessments, not the supplier catalogue. For each role, list the residual hazards that PPE must address, then specify the item and its protection level, and reference the marking that proves it: EN 397 for industrial helmets, EN 166 for eye protection, EN 388 for mechanical gloves, EN ISO 20345 for safety footwear, EN 361 for fall-arrest harnesses. Where a South African or other standard applies to a purchase, cite it the same way. The matrix is the purchasing order, the issue record's parent, and the auditor's first request.

4.5 Issue, inspect, retire

Every issue is signed for, employee name, item, size, date, condition. Inspections have two rhythms: before-use by the wearer, trained in Level 1 habits, and scheduled periodic inspection by a competent person, recorded on a register. Retirement rules must be unambiguous. A hard hat: replace after any significant impact, after the manufacturer's service life, and on visible damage; the date code on the shell starts the clock. A harness: retire on any shock loading, on cuts or chemical attack, and per manufacturer life; harnesses that have arrested a fall never return to service. Respirators need fit-testing for tight-fitting models and filter change schedules, not eyeball judgement.

Store PPE dry, out of sun, clean, and separated by person where hygiene demands it, shared respirators are a hygiene and fit problem at once. Charge and check anything battery-powered weekly, including head torches and gas detectors, on a written schedule.

4.6 What markings do and do not mean

A standard marking says the item met a laboratory specification when manufactured. It does not say the item is right for your hazard, still serviceable, or legally required. Selection logic runs hazard first, specification second, condition third. The safety officer who can say “we use EN 388 level 4131 gloves because the risk assessment's cut score demands it, and this pair failed its inspection” is citing three different documents correctly, and everyone can follow the chain.

4.7 Worked example

Worked example: A road contractor's audit finds gloves in use with no markings, harnesses with illegible labels, and hard hats of five different colours with no issue records. The rebuild: PPE matrix per role from the risk assessment; issue register opened with signatures; all unmarked gloves retired and replaced to matrix specification; each harness tagged with serial, issue date, inspection date and inspector initials, and one harness retired outright after the register showed a fall arrest last quarter that nobody had actioned. Monthly inspection walks now sample five items against the register. Cost of the rebuild: a weekend of administration and one harness. Cost of the alternative: an unsupported compensation claim and a possible fatality with a known, documented, ignored history.

4.8 Activity and knowledge check

LEARNER ACTIVITY

Build the register

Groups receive a role card, for example “warehouse picker, reach truck aisles, cold store entry weekly”, and the course PPE sample table. Produce: the role's PPE matrix rows, an issue-record design, and the periodic inspection schedule with retirement rules. Swap with another group and audit theirs for a hazard with no specified item, and an item with no retirement rule.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

PPE inspection and management — check your understanding

1. Where does a PPE programme start?

   A. The supplier catalogue

   B. The risk assessments

C. The cheapest compliant option

2. A harness has arrested one fall and shows no damage. What happens?

A. Return to service after inspection

B. Retire permanently

C. Keep as a spare

3. What does an EN 397 marking tell you?

4. Name the two inspection rhythms for PPE and who owns each.

5. List any four fields a PPE issue record should carry.

4.9 Module summary

- The matrix runs from risk assessments to specifications to markings.
- Issue is signed; inspection is scheduled; retirement rules are absolute.
- Harnesses that arrested a fall are finished; hard hats have service lives.
- Markings prove manufacture specification, nothing more.

Module 5 Emergency preparedness and fire safety

Contact time: 3.5 hours · *Oryx Safety Academy*

5.1 What this module covers

This module plans emergencies rather than surviving them: the written plan, the evacuation diagram, the drill cycle, and fire science at officer level, fuel classes, spread mechanisms, extinguishing media, and equipment maintenance. Practical extinguisher use is scheduled as a live session delivered through a qualified fire-training provider; this classroom module prepares you to pass it and to own the site's arrangements afterwards.

5.2 Learning outcomes

By the end of this module you should be able to:

- Draft the core of a site emergency plan: roles, alarm, routes, assembly, and communications.
- Read and brief an evacuation diagram, including for visitors and people with limited mobility.
- Run a drill cycle with objectives, observation and a written debrief.

- Classify fires by fuel and specify the correct medium and the media that must not be used.
- Set up and record monthly and annual fire-equipment checks with competent servicing.

5.3 Key terminology

Term	Working definition
Emergency plan	The written arrangement answering: alarm, routes, assembly, roles, communications.
Fire load	The quantity and nature of combustible material in a space, which determines potential severity.
Drill debrief	The written record of what a drill tested, what failed, and the dated fixes.
Competent servicing	Maintenance by a person or firm with the equipment knowledge and authority to certify it.

5.4 The plan on one page

Every site plan answers the same five questions: how the alarm is raised, including a distinct sound nobody can mistake for a shift signal; the routes, primary and alternative, with dimensions that fit the headcount; the assembly point and its roll-call method; the roles, who leads, who sweeps, who counts, who meets the responders, all with named alternates; and communications, including the numbers posted where a visitor can find them. Sites with hazardous substances add spill and exposure response; sites with many contractors add a briefing step at induction.

5.5 Drills that teach

A drill is a test with a syllabus. Announce the first one; test routes and count. Unannounced later drills test response time and behaviour, blocked exits, night shift, missing persons. Every drill has an observer with a checklist, a stopwatch, and no rescue duties, and every drill ends in a written debrief with dated actions. The debrief is the product; the evacuation is the demonstration.

5.6 Fire at officer level

Fire needs fuel, oxygen and heat; remove one and it stops. Solids smoulder and burn to ash; liquids vaporise and burn at the surface with flame spread that follows spills and drains; gases burn at the release point until the source is

closed; electrical involvement is a live conductor problem until isolated; cooking oils superheat beyond water's flash-to-steam point, which is why water on a chip-pan fire is a violent steam explosion. Extinguishing media follow: water cools solids; foam blankets liquids; dry powder interrupts the flame chemistry and handles liquid and electrical involvement with collateral mess; carbon dioxide displaces oxygen and suits electrical and liquid fires in enclosed spaces; wet chemical saponifies cooking oil. Spread mechanisms, direct flame, conduction, convection, radiation, plus the behaviour of smoke as the actual killer in buildings, drive the real priorities: raise the alarm, evacuate, close doors, let the service work.

Extinguishers are first-aid appliances: for a fire that is small, contained, and in your trained hands, with your escape route behind you. The officer's deeper duty is the equipment regime: monthly visual checks, pressure gauges, seals, access, signage, and annual competent servicing, all recorded. Hose reels, hydrants, sprinklers and detection systems carry their own servicing schedules; the site file lists them together.

5.7 The live practical

Extinguisher technique is assessed hands-on in the provider-led session: PASS, pull, aim, squeeze, sweep, at the right distance, on the right class of fire, with the wind at your back. Arrive knowing the theory cold; the practical then builds muscle memory rather than vocabulary. Sites schedule refresher practice in line with the provider's recommendation and record attendance in the training register.

5.7 Worked example

Worked example: A lodge near Outjo writes its first emergency plan. Alarm: an air-raid siren recovered from a farm shed, tested weekly, distinct from the dinner gong it replaced after a drill evacuated the dining room into the wrong direction. Routes: two, marked with reflective signage after the debrief noted guests followed staff, and staff followed habit, into the kitchen. Assembly: the staff village, upwind of the usual evening breeze. Roles: night auditor leads at night; a named housekeeper sweeps the west wing; management meets the fire service at the gate with the guest list. Communications: numbers posted at reception, kitchen and bar, plus the nearest ambulance service's direct line, since the national number's routing added nine minutes in the test call. One page, one drill, four fixes, one debrief: that is the whole method.

5.8 Activity and knowledge check

LEARNER ACTIVITY

Plan and debrief

Groups receive a simple site plan, a warehouse with an office wing, a flammable store, and thirty staff including two wheelchair users. Produce the one-page plan. Then the facilitator injects a complication, the western exit is blocked, and the group revises the plan in ten minutes and writes a three-line debrief. Swap plans between groups and audit each against the five questions.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Emergency preparedness and fire safety — check your understanding

1. Name the five questions every emergency plan answers.
2. Water must not be used on flammable liquid fires or cooking-oil fires. Give the reason for each.
3. Which medium suits a live electrical fire in an enclosed switch room?
   A. Water
   B. Foam
   C. Carbon dioxide or dry powder
4. What two checks form the monthly extinguisher routine, and what happens annually?
5. What makes a drill a drill rather than an evacuation?

5.9 Module summary

- Five questions, one page, named alternates.
- Drills are tests with syllabi; debriefs are the product.
- Media follow fuel; smoke and evacuation outrank firefighting.
- Monthly visual checks, annual competent servicing, all recorded.

Module 6 First aid awareness

Contact time: 2.5 hours · *Oryx Safety Academy*

6.1 What this module covers

This module is deliberately named awareness. It equips the safety officer to arrange and manage first aid, not to substitute for a first aider. Certification in

First Aid Level 1 or higher is issued through a registered Namibian first-aid training partner under a separate programme; this module explains what that arrangement is, what a compliant site looks like, and the correct first response while waiting for qualified help.

6.2 Learning outcomes

By the end of this module you should be able to:

- State what first aid is and what it is not, including the certification boundary on Oryx courses.
- Determine first-aid provision expectations for a workplace under GN 156 of 1997, including boxes, contents and trained cover per shift.
- Manage the first response to bleeding, burns, fractures and unconsciousness while awaiting trained help.
- Check and restock a first-aid box on a schedule, with records.
- Brief a partner-delivered First Aid Level 1 course and integrate certificates into the training register.

6.3 Key terminology

Term	Working definition
First aider	A person trained and certified to provide initial treatment; on Oryx-linked sites, certified by a registered Namibian first-aid training partner.
First-aid box	The stocked, marked, accessible container required by the regulations, contents checked on a schedule.
DRSABCD	Danger, Response, Send for help, Airway, Breathing, CPR, Defibrillation: the primary survey sequence used by trained first aiders.
Scope of practice	What a person is trained and certified to do; acting beyond it creates risk for everyone.

6.4 The boundary, stated plainly

Oryx does not issue first-aid certificates. First Aid Level 1 certification runs through a registered Namibian first-aid training partner under a separate arrangement, with the partner's instructors and the partner's certificate. This course teaches you to manage that arrangement: who is trained, how cover per shift is maintained, where boxes and equipment live, and how the whole thing is recorded. A safety officer performing CPR trained only from a book is outside

scope of practice; the same officer arranging six certified first aiders across three shifts is doing exactly the job.

6.5 What the site owes

Government Notice 156 of 1997 sets the first-aid expectations for Namibian workplaces: adequately equipped boxes, their number and contents scaled to the workforce, positioned visibly and accessible at all times, with trained first-aid cover where numbers and risk demand it. The exact scaling should be read from the current gazetted text and the workplace's own risk profile; a workshop with burn and crush risks justifies more than headcount alone suggests. Records tie it together: box check schedules, contents restocking, and first-aid training certificates in the register with expiry tracking.

6.6 The first response while help comes

For severe bleeding: protect yourself, press the wound with a clean pad, elevate where possible, do not remove soaked dressings, add on top. For burns: cool the burn, cool water, for a sustained period, no ice, no ointments, no butter, no ice, and nothing peeled off. For suspected fractures: still is better than straight; support the limb as found and let trained help move it. For an unconscious breathing person: the recovery position protects the airway. For a non-breathing person: send for help and an defibrillator immediately and hand over to the trained responder. In every case the officer's real duties are the system ones: getting help fast, clearing access for it, and recording what happened.

6.7 Worked example

Worked example: A supermarket's first-aid arrangements are audited. Findings: one box for ninety staff across two floors and a bakery; contents last checked at an unknown date, including expired burn dressings; two certified first aiders, both on day shift, none for the evening replenishment crew that does the manual handling. Fixes: boxes per regulations on both floors plus a bakery-specific burns kit; monthly check schedule with a named owner and a signed register; two evening staff booked onto the partner's First Aid Level 1 course with certificates filed and expiry dates diarised; emergency numbers and first-aider names posted at every exit. Nothing heroic, all of it load-bearing.

6.8 Activity and knowledge check

> **LEARNER ACTIVITY**
>
> **Audit the box**

Groups receive the course first-aid box and a contents schedule. Check against the schedule: what is missing, what is expired, what is damaged. Draft the monthly check sheet the site should use, then swap with another group and find the field their sheet forgot, most groups forget the restock date and the checker's signature.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

First aid awareness — check your understanding

1. Does this Oryx course certify you in first aid?
   A. Yes, at awareness level
   B. No; certification runs through a registered Namibian first-aid training partner
   C. Yes, if you pass the exam
2. Cool a burn with…
   A. Ice
   B. Cool water for a sustained period
   C. Butter or ointment
3. A soaked dressing on a bleeding wound should be…
   A. Removed and replaced
   B. Left and reinforced on top
   C. Rinsed and reapplied
4. Name three system duties of the safety officer in a medical emergency.
5. What does DRSABCD stand for?

6.9 Module summary

- Oryx certifies awareness only; First Aid Level 1 comes from the registered partner.
- GN 156 scales boxes, contents and cover to the workforce; records prove it.
- First response: bleeding, burns, fractures, airway, while help comes.
- The officer's job is the system: help, access, records.

Module 7 Construction-site safety

Contact time: 3.5 hours · *Oryx Safety Academy*

7.1 What this module covers

Construction concentrates nearly every hazard category into one moving site. This module covers the high-risk subjects a safety officer must know cold, scaffolds, work at height, excavations, electricity and mobile plant, framed within Namibian law and honest about which standards are good practice. The recurring theme is the same one auditors use: is the safe method written, resourced and checked, or improvised?

7.2 Learning outcomes

By the end of this module you should be able to:

- List the high-risk construction activities that need a written, controlled method before work starts.
- Inspect a scaffold systematically against a checklist and state common faults that stop work.
- Specify the protective measures for excavations, edges, openings and fragile surfaces.
- Describe the electrical safety arrangements a non-electrician officer verifies: isolation, protection, inspection of leads and tools.
- Manage mobile plant and pedestrian separation, including delivery and reversing operations.

7.3 Key terminology

Term	Working definition
Working at height	Any work where a fall could cause injury, including below-ground work near openings; there is no two-metre exemption in logic, whatever local myth says.
Scaffold tag	The status marker recording the last inspection, the inspector, and whether the scaffold is fit for use.
Permit to work	A written authorisation for defined high-risk work with defined precautions, signed on and off.
Exclusion zone	A physically marked area that keeps people out of a hazard's reach, for example below lifting operations.

7.4 The legal frame and the honest standard

Namibian law on construction safety is the Labour Act and GN 156, which apply fully to construction sites, machinery and welfare. There is no dedicated

Namibian construction regulation equivalent to South Africa's 2014 Construction Regulations; many Namibian clients import them contractually, and standards such as SANS 10085 for scaffolding and SANS 10292? no, SANS 10298 and the like, circulate as good practice. The professional position: comply with Namibian law absolutely, follow the client's contractual standards where they are stricter, and label every citation honestly in the safety file. This course teaches generic good practice that satisfies both.

7.5 Scaffolds and work at height

A scaffold is a structure: base plates and firm ground, standards plumb, ledgers level, ties per design, full boarding, guardrails and toe boards on working platforms, safe access ladders secured and extending properly, and a current inspection tag by a competent person, before first use, after alteration, after weather, and on a weekly rhythm. Faults that stop work include missing ties, missing guardrails, incomplete boards, mixed-component scaffolds, and damaged or uncertified components. Ladders are access, not workplaces; a task taking more than about thirty minutes at a ladder needs a platform.

Falls are managed by the same hierarchy as any hazard: eliminate the work at height where possible, collective protection, guardrails and covers, before personal protection, harnesses with EN 361-marked equipment, inspected, with anchor points designed by someone competent and rescue arranged before the first clip-in, because a suspended worker dies of suspension trauma in minutes, not hours.

7.6 Excavations

A trench kills quietly: soil does not need to be deep, collapse is sudden, and burial is usually fatal. Controls: locate services before digging, support or batter the sides where depth and soil demand, keep spoil and plant away from edges, edge protection and marked access, daily inspection by a competent person before entry and after rain, and a no-entry rule for unsupported excavations, which are treated as confined spaces when they accumulate water or fumes.

7.7 Electricity and mobile plant

The non-electrician officer verifies arrangements rather than doing the work: connections made and maintained by competent persons; distribution boards closed, labelled and earthed; residual-current protection on supplies to tools; leads routed up and away from damage, never in water; tools and leads visually checked by users and formally inspected and tested on a schedule; and isolation locked and tagged for work on systems. Mobile plant: separation is the whole game, physical barriers and marked walkways, banksman-controlled reversing,

exclusion zones under lifts, daily operator checks, and keys controlled so that the untrained do not move what the trained cannot see past.

7.7 Worked example

Worked example: A two-storey office extension in Swakopmund. Monday inspection finds: scaffold without ties for its top lift, boards with gaps, tag missing; extension leads running through a puddle to a planer; excavator reversing unprompted near the tea shelter; a 1.5 m trench beside the walkway, unsupported, spoil at the edge. Officer's actions: scaffold red-tagged until the competent person rectifies and re-tags, the top lift is barricaded below; leads isolated and rerouted with RCD verified; reversing rule reinstated with a banksman for the day and mirror-cones ordered; trench barriered with an access gate, inspection scheduled daily, spoil moved back. Work continues everywhere except the two stopped areas, which is the point: stopping the hazard, not the site.

7.8 Activity and knowledge check

LEARNER ACTIVITY

Scaffold checklist walk

Using the course scaffold photographs and the checklist in your workbook, score each image: components, ties, boarding, guardrails, access, tag. Mark each fault stop-work or monitor. Then write the three-line inspection report you would leave on site for the worst image.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Construction-site safety — check your understanding

1. Is there a dedicated Namibian construction safety regulation equivalent to South Africa's Construction Regulations 2014?

   A. Yes, since 2014

   B. No; the Labour Act and GN 156 apply, with SA instruments used as contractual good practice

   C. Only in Walvis Bay

2. List any four stop-work faults on a scaffold.

3. What must be arranged before the first harness clip-in at height?

4. A 1.2 m trench in loose sand beside a walkway. Give the controls.

5. What does the non-electrician safety officer verify about site electricity?

7.9 Module summary

- Namibian law applies; SA standards are contractual good practice, labelled honestly.
- Scaffolds are structures: ties, boards, guardrails, tags, competent inspection.
- Trenches kill quietly: support, edge control, daily inspection.
- Electricity is verified, not improvised; plant and people are separated.

Module 8 Toolbox talks and safety meetings

Contact time: 1.5 hours · *Oryx Safety Academy*

8.1 What this module covers

A safety officer who cannot talk to a crew is a filing clerk. This module builds the two speaking formats of the job: the five-minute toolbox talk that changes tomorrow's behaviour, and the safety meeting that moves the site's system. Both are assessable: your ten-minute toolbox talk is part of the final assessment.

8.2 Learning outcomes

By the end of this module you should be able to:

- Plan and deliver a five-minute toolbox talk on one hazard, to a standard rubric.
- Select topics from the site's live risk information rather than a generic list.
- Chair a safety meeting with an agenda, minutes, and actions that carry owners and dates.
- Handle resistance and silence in a way that keeps reports coming.

8.3 Key terminology

Term	Working definition
Toolbox talk	A short, single-topic safety briefing at the workface, ideally delivered with the crew standing where the hazard is.
Safety meeting	A scheduled, minuted meeting of site management and worker representatives on safety matters.

Term	Working definition
Minutes with actions	The written record whose value is the action list: what, who, by when.

8.4 The talk that works

One hazard. Five minutes. At the workface if possible, with the thing you are talking about in front of the crew. Structure: what we are doing today; the one thing that can hurt us; how we do it safely, demonstrated or pointed at; who checks; and one question to the crew to close, because a talk that ends in silence has taught nothing you can verify. Sign the attendance sheet, file it, and pick tomorrow's topic from the site's live information: the near misses, the inspection findings, the new crew, the new machine, the weather.

Delivery: speak to the newest person present, in plain language, no acronym left unexplained, and no shaming of anyone's yesterday. The talk is where the site's safety paperwork becomes the crew's knowledge, or fails to.

8.5 The meeting that moves things

The safety meeting is the system's heartbeat: a fixed rhythm, a standing agenda, hazards raised, actions reviewed, new risks tabled, statistics glanced at, and minutes with owners and dates. The chair's discipline is to keep every item converging on an action or a decision, park debates without owners, and start every meeting by reviewing the last meeting's action list aloud, because the fastest way to kill a safety meeting is letting actions evaporate twice in a row.

Under the pending OSH Bill, larger employers may expect mandated safety committees; nothing changes about the craft: agenda, minutes, actions, follow-up.

8.6 Silence and resistance

Silence usually means fear or futility, not agreement. Counter with small, safe questions, “what is the most annoying part of this job”, and visible action on the first answers, however small. Resistance, “we have always done it this way”, deserves respect and a factual answer: what the risk assessment says, what happened the last time, and what changes on Monday. You will not win every room; you must be seen to act on every reasonable report.

8.7 Worked example

Worked example: A site's toolbox talks were thirty-minute read-alouds of generic topics, attendance signed, nothing changing. The new officer rebuilds them:

Monday, scafftags, standing at the scaffold, five minutes, the tag shown, one crew question, one fault fixed on the spot; Wednesday, the trench, standing at the trench, the competent person demonstrates the daily check; Friday, the week's near misses read by role, one question: which of these could have been you? Attendance unchanged, near-miss reports tripled within a month, because the crew could finally see the talks ending in something.

8.8 Activity and knowledge check

LEARNER ACTIVITY

Two minutes, one hazard

Each learner draws a topic card, for example “reversing telehandler”, and delivers two minutes of a toolbox talk to a small group, using the rubric from the assessment pack: one hazard, plain language, how to work safely, who checks, closing question. Groups score each other and nominate one talk for the whole class. This rehearses the assessed ten-minute talk; treat the feedback as draft feedback.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Toolbox talks and safety meetings — check your understanding

1. What are the five structural elements of a toolbox talk taught in this module?
2. Where should a toolbox talk happen, and why?
3. What kills a safety meeting fastest?
4. Name two sources for choosing talk topics that are better than a generic list.
5. The crew answers your closing question with silence. What is the likely meaning and one response?

8.9 Module summary

- One hazard, five minutes, at the workface, ending in a question.
- Meetings live on agendas, minutes, and actions with owners and dates.
- Topics come from live site information.
- Act visibly on reports or watch reporting die.

Module 9 Safety files and site documentation

Contact time: 2 hours · *Oryx Safety Academy*

9.1 What this module covers

The safety file is where the site's safety system becomes visible and checkable. This module assembles one: what belongs inside, how documents are controlled so the current version is the one on the wall, and how the permit-to-work discipline governs the highest-risk tasks. An auditor should be able to reconstruct your site's whole safety story from the file, and so should your successor.

9.2 Learning outcomes

By the end of this module you should be able to:

- List the contents of a complete site safety file and assemble one from a checklist.
- Control document versions so superseded copies leave the wall and the site.
- Explain permit-to-work logic and operate a basic permit for hot work or work at height.
- Maintain the registers, training, inspection, incident, PPE, plant, as living records rather than archived paper.
- Hand over a safety file that a successor or auditor can navigate in ten minutes.

9.3 Key terminology

Term	Working definition
Safety file	The controlled collection of a site's safety documents and registers, current, complete and indexed.
Document control	The system ensuring only the current approved version is in use, with distribution and withdrawal records.
Permit to work	A written, signed authorisation for defined high-risk work with defined precautions, valid for a defined time.
Register	A running record, training, inspection, incidents, PPE issues, plant checks, maintained as events occur.

9.4 What goes in the file

A complete file carries: the site's safety policy and organisation, roles named; the risk assessments, current; the safe work procedures for the site's high-risk tasks; the training register with certificates and expiries; the inspection records,

scaffold, plant, excavations, PPE; the incident and near-miss records with investigation reports; the emergency plan and drill records; the PPE matrix and issue records; the plant and equipment list with maintenance evidence; the permit-to-work book, used; the contractor and visitor records; and the correspondence that shows the safety conversation with clients and authorities. Index it, date it, and keep one master with controlled copies where work happens.

9.5 Versions and validity

An out-of-date procedure on the wall is worse than none, because it is trusted. Control means: approved versions numbered and dated; a distribution list; withdrawal of superseded copies recorded; and a review date on everything living. The test of the system is brutal and simple: pick any document on the wall and ask any worker's supervisor which version it is and where the master lives.

9.6 Permits for the worst minutes

Permits exist because some work, hot work, work at height, confined-space entry, live electrical work, excavation near services, has minutes in which an ordinary mistake is fatal. A permit forces the conversation: what exactly will happen, what could go wrong, what precautions are in place, who checked, when it starts, when it ends, and who signs it off. The discipline is closure: a permit that is not signed off at the end is an alarm bell about the site's whole attitude. The safety officer audits permits for completeness and pattern, permits that never record a problem are permits nobody is reading.

9.7 Worked example

Worked example: An auditor asks a new officer to demonstrate the file. It opens with an index; the policy is signed and dated; each risk assessment names assessors and review triggers; the training register shows two first-aid certificates expiring next month with the refresher booking noted; scaffold inspections appear weekly with one gap, annotated with the site closure that explains it; the near-miss section is embarrassingly full and each entry has a follow-up; the permit book shows twelve permits, eleven signed off, one annotated “not closed, crew left at knock-off, reviewed at next toolbox talk, rule re-issued”. The auditor's report runs one line: file demonstrates a functioning system. That sentence is the module's entire objective.

9.8 Activity and knowledge check

LEARNER ACTIVITY

Assemble and audit

Groups receive a shuffled document pack, a mixed site history in paper form. Assemble the safety file to the checklist, then audit the neighbouring group's file: one document missing, one out of date, one register with a gap that tells a story. Report your three findings as an auditor would: finding, evidence, required action, date.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Safety files and site documentation — check your understanding

1. List any eight contents of a complete site safety file.
2. Why is a superseded document on the wall worse than no document?
3. Name four activities that typically require a permit to work.
4. What does an un-closed permit indicate?
5. What is the ten-minute test for a safety file?

9.9 Module summary

- The file is the visible, checkable safety system, indexed and current.
- Version control: numbered, dated, distributed, withdrawn, reviewed.
- Permits govern the minutes where mistakes are fatal; closure is the discipline.
- Registers are living records, not archives.

Module 10 The practical site walkthrough

Contact time: 3 hours + final examination · *Oryx Safety Academy*

10.1 What this module covers

The walkthrough is where the course stops being knowledge and becomes performance. You will inspect a real or simulated site with a checklist, classify findings, decide what to stop and what to monitor, communicate to the crew, and write the inspection report. It is assessed by observation against a published rubric, and it rehearses the routine you will run weekly for the rest of your career.

10.2 Learning outcomes

By the end of this module you should be able to:

- Plan a walkthrough: route, documents carried, who accompanies, what yesterday's records say.
- Inspect systematically, using the area and task sweep patterns from Module 2.
- Classify findings as stop-work, fix-with-date, or monitor, and justify each classification.
- Communicate findings on site, to the crew and the supervisor, without blame and without vagueness.
- Write the follow-up report with actions, owners and dates, and file it in the safety file.

10.3 Key terminology

Term	Working definition
Finding	A specific observed condition or behaviour, stated with location and evidence.
Classification	The decision a finding demands: stop, fix by date, or monitor.
Walkthrough report	The written record of findings, classifications, actions, owners and dates from an inspection.

10.4 Before you walk

Read before stepping out: the last walkthrough report and whether its actions closed; the near-miss entries since; the permits open today; the new crews and equipment. Choose the route to cover the high-risk areas at the time their work is live, the scaffold when the scaffolders are on it, the loading yard when the trucks are in. Carry the checklist, the camera, the tag roll, and yesterday's paperwork. Bring the supervisor: findings communicated in the moment change more than findings emailed on Friday.

10.5 While you walk

Follow the pattern: perimeter, services, plant, storage, workfaces, welfare, in a fixed order so nothing depends on memory. At each area, sweep high, low, behind, and at what moves. Talk to workers as inspectors, not police: what is the most dangerous thing you do here; what nearly happened this week. Note the

good, too, a report that only ever lists failures teaches the site to hide. Photograph findings with a reference, tag stop-work items physically, and tell the nearest supervisor now, not later.

10.6 After you walk

Convert notes to findings the same day while memory is fresh: location, condition or behaviour observed, the hazard it creates, the classification, the action, the owner, the date. Stop-work items get action before the report is finished; that is what stop means. The report goes to the site manager and the safety file; actions go into the register and are reviewed at the next safety meeting; the next walkthrough starts by checking they closed. The loop, closed weekly, is the entire job description in miniature.

10.7 Worked example

Worked example: The assessed walkthrough finds, in ninety minutes on a light-industrial site: a fire exit blocked by stacked pallets, stop, pallets moved during the inspection, action recorded as closed; a missing scaffold tag, stop, re-inspection before next use, competent person named, by 16:00 today; a torn hi-vis vest, fix, replacement issued from store, register signed; forklift speeding in the yard, fix, toolbox talk scheduled for tomorrow morning, supervisor owning it; a first-aid box restocked last week, noted as good; three near-miss forms from the loading crew, praised publicly at the next meeting. Five findings, two stops, one piece of good news, one talk, all owners named, all dated. That is the rhythm.

10.8 Activity and knowledge check

LEARNER ACTIVITY

The assessed walkthrough

Conducted at the partner site or the simulated site circuit as scheduled on day five. You will be observed against the published rubric: preparation, system, safety of your own conduct, communication, classification judgement, and the written report submitted within 24 hours. Read the rubric before the day; it is in the assessment pack and was written to be read.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

The practical site walkthrough — check your understanding

1. Name four things to read before starting a walkthrough.

2. Why bring the supervisor on the walk?
3. A fire exit is blocked by pallets. Classify it and state the action.
4. Why record good practice in a walkthrough report?
5. What happens to walkthrough actions at the next safety meeting?

10.9 Module summary

- Read yesterday, walk today, report the same day.
- Fixed pattern, live timing, supervisor alongside, crew consulted.
- Classify: stop, fix by date, monitor; say why.
- Actions with owners and dates, reviewed until closed.

Revision and progression

Rework the knowledge checks closed-book. Rehearse your toolbox talk aloud at least three times; the assessed version rewards rehearsal more than talent. Before the walkthrough, re-read Module 10 and the rubric, and read yesterday's near-miss reports from your own workplace to prime your eye.

Progression: Level 3, Advanced Safety Management, is a modular ten-day programme for senior safety officers and SHE managers, covering SHEQ systems, ISO 45001 principles, occupational hygiene, contractor management, advanced investigation, auditing and training-of-trainers. Completion of Level 2 is the entry requirement.

References and further reading

References follow a consistent author–date style; legal references cite jurisdiction, short title, year and authority. Every entry is recorded in the Oryx Safety Academy Research and Reference Register with reliability tier and review status. Where a provision's current numbering is uncertain, verify against the official gazetted text rather than relying on secondary summaries.

[R1] Namibia (2007). Labour Act, 2007 (Act No. 11 of 2007). Windhoek: Government Gazette. Text via the Legal Assistance Centre laws archive, https://www.lac.org.na/laws/. Accessed 2 November 2026.

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[R3] Namibia (1946). Employees' Compensation Ordinance, 1946 (Ordinance 36 of 1946), as amended; administered through the Employees' Compensation Fund, Social Security Commission, http://www.ssc.org.na. Accessed 2 November 2026.

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[R7] Ministry of Labour, Industrial Relations and Employment Creation (2024). Annual report, https://mol.gov.na. Accessed 2 November 2026.

[R8] International Labour Organization (1981). Occupational Safety and Health Convention, 1981 (No. 155). Geneva: ILO. Confirm Namibia's ratification status on ILO NORMLEX before asserting it.

[R9] International Labour Organization (1992). Safety and Health in Construction: An ILO Code of Practice. Geneva: ILO.

[R10] International Organization for Standardization (2018). ISO 45001:2018 Occupational Health and Safety Management Systems. Geneva: ISO.

[R11] South Africa (2014). Construction Regulations, 2014, under the Occupational Health and Safety Act, 1993 (Act 85 of 1993). Pretoria: Government Gazette. South African law, used in Namibia as contractual good practice where clients specify it, not as Namibian statute.

[R12] Oryx Institute (2026). Oryx Safety Academy course pages, https://www.oryxinstitute.org/practice/safety-officer-course. Accessed 2 November 2026.

Glossary

Terms are defined as used in this manual. Where a term has a statutory definition, the statute prevails.

Term	Definition
Area-based sweep	Hazard identification walking one physical area in a fixed pattern.
Corrective action	A dated, owned change that removes a cause.
Document control	Ensuring only the current approved version of a document is in use.

Term	Definition
DRSABCD	Danger, Response, Send for help, Airway, Breathing, CPR, Defibrillation.
Emergency plan	The written arrangement: alarm, routes, assembly, roles, communications.
Employees' Compensation Fund	SSC-administered fund compensating work injuries under the 1946 Ordinance.
EN standard marking	European norm marking on PPE, a specification reference, not a Namibian legal requirement.
Exclusion zone	A physically marked area keeping people out of a hazard's reach.
Finding	A specific observed condition or behaviour with location and evidence.
GN 156 of 1997	Regulations relating to the health and safety of employees at work.
Hierarchy of control	Elimination, substitution, engineering, administrative, PPE.
HIRA	Hazard identification and risk assessment.
Improvement notice / Prohibition notice	An inspector's written instruction to fix a breach / to stop activity involving risk of serious injury.
Permit to work	Written authorisation for defined high-risk work with defined precautions.
PPE matrix	Table linking roles, hazards, specified equipment and standards.
Residual risk	Risk remaining after controls.
Risk matrix	Likelihood-by-severity grid used to rank risks consistently.
Scaffold tag	Status marker recording the last competent inspection.
Scope of practice	What a person is trained and certified to do.
Task-based sweep	Hazard identification following one job step by step.
Toolbox talk	A short, single-topic briefing at the workface.
Underlying cause	The system fault that allowed an immediate cause to exist.

Feedback and support

Your evaluation form feeds the course review cycle. Report errors or unclear passages on the day, or write to info@oryxinstitute.org; corrections are logged, reviewed and credited.